

CURATED SOURCE CORPUS

AI Chess Coach Library

A broad, retrieval-ready bestseller shelf for openings, strategy, middlegames, thinking and calculation, tactics, attack and defence, endgames, practical improvement, and master games.

103	95	9
catalogued books	official excerpts installed	subject shelves

This expansion adds 64 non-opening titles and 57 publisher excerpts while preserving the existing 39-book opening shelf.

20 JULY 2026 / OUTPOST - EN CROISSANT FORK

What has been assembled

This is a deliberately broad source shelf for a future analysis coach. It is not a dump of every available chess title. The selection favours respected grandmasters, elite trainers, prize-winning or enduring books, modern editions, complementary teaching styles, and passages that can explain a player's decision after the engine has identified the critical position.

THE COLLECTION	COUNT	LOCAL MATERIAL
Existing opening shelf	39	38 official publisher excerpts catalogued
New all-aspects shelf	64	57 official publisher excerpts installed; the remainder are acquisition entries
Combined retrieval catalogue	103	One JSON manifest plus this human-readable catalogue

Rights and truth boundary

LAWFUL CORPUS

Only publisher-authorized sample or excerpt PDFs are installed. Full editions remain acquisition items and must be purchased or supplied from copies the user lawfully owns. Do not redistribute the installed excerpts.

The catalogue records books not yet installed because a source map is useful before acquisition. The coach should never imply that an excerpt represents the whole book, and it should quote only within the user's lawful access and the product's copyright rules.

Coverage map

SHELF	BOOKS	WHY IT EXISTS	RETRIEVAL SIGNALS
Opening Books	39	Opening identity, plans, move orders, repertoire choices, and theory	opening, ECO, move order, repertoire, novelty
Strategy and Positional Play	13	Plans, imbalances, prophylaxis, piece improvement, structures, and long-term decision-making	quiet moves, weak squares, exchanges, imbalances, plans, prophylaxis
Middlegame and Pawn Structures	7	The transition from opening to middlegame, pawn structures, exchanges, and recurring technical themes	pawn structure, middlegame plan, exchange decision, piece coordination
Thinking and Calculation	11	Candidate moves, visualization, calculation discipline, evaluation, time use, and the psychology of error	candidate moves, calculate, visualize, clock, blunder, decision process
Tactics and Combinations	6	Pattern recognition, forcing play, mating attacks, tactical defence, and deliberate exercise practice	tactic, combination, forcing move, mating pattern, swindle
Attack and Defence	4	Building attacks, converting initiative, resisting threats, counterplay, and defensive resourcefulness	king attack, initiative, defence, counterattack, danger
Endgames	12	Essential theory, practical technique, rook endings, patterns, tactics, and modern tablebase corrections	endgame, rook ending, conversion, fortress, theoretical position
Practical Improvement and Computer Chess	4	Training design, engine-assisted learning, modern chess discoveries, resilience, and transferable lessons	training plan, engine, AlphaZero, improvement, practical decision
Master Games and Chess Wisdom	7	Deeply annotated games, elite-player self-explanation, historical styles, and whole-game understanding	model game, player style, whole game, annotated game, chess history

Thinking and calculation is a major shelf

This category is intentionally separate from tactics. Tactics asks whether a forcing idea exists. Calculation asks how a player generates candidates, visualizes branches, compares resulting positions, manages time, notices bias, and knows when to stop. Those failures require different lessons and different passages.

COACHING LANE	WHAT THE COACH SHOULD DIAGNOSE	PRIMARY SOURCES
Candidate generation	Was the right move never considered, rejected too early, or hidden behind an automatic recapture?	Aagaard: Calculation; Ramesh; Tisdall
Visualization and comparison	Did the line become blurry, stop too early, or end without evaluating the final position?	Ramesh; Aagaard; Think Like a Super-GM
Decision type and clock	Was this a calculation position, a simple choice, a strategic judgement, or a moment to conserve time?	Thinking Inside the Box; The Secret Ingredient
Cognitive and emotional error	Did materialism, fear, desire, ego, frustration, or a fixed mindset distort the choice?	Rowson; Hymer and Wells; Markos and Navara
Training response	What exercise, repetition cycle, self-analysis routine, or study block follows from this game?	Pump Up Your Rating; How to Study Chess on Your Own; Woodpecker

Recommended retrieval sequence

1. Locate the critical position

Use engine swings, missed tactics, time usage, and the player's question to identify the learning moment.

2. Classify the failure

Opening knowledge, tactical vision, calculation process, positional judgement, defence, technique, or practical psychology.

3. Retrieve complementary passages

Prefer one explanatory source, one concrete model game, and one exercise source when all three exist.

4. Resolve conflicts

State disagreements between authors or editions. Use tablebases and current engines for exact verification, while books remain the source of human concepts.

5. Produce the lesson

Explain the position in the player's language, cite book and page, distinguish quotation from synthesis, and propose one small training action.

6. Build the mini-PDF

Include only pages the user lawfully possesses, add a generated connective summary, and preserve source and page attribution.

Acquisition plan

The installed excerpts are enough to prototype search, citation, ranking, and answer synthesis. Full-book acquisition should proceed in tiers so the corpus gains broad explanatory coverage before specialist depth.

TIER	PURPOSE	WHAT TO ACQUIRE FIRST
Foundation	One dependable source for each recurring coaching problem	Every title marked foundation across all shelves; prioritise calculation, structures, essential endings, defence, and move-by-move games
Core	Competing explanations and richer examples	Decision-making series, exchange books, psychology, attack patterns, practical rook endings, and annotated legends
Specialist	Depth for rare or advanced questions	Nunn's advanced endings, Endgame Labyrinths, and reflective chess essays

Source-style balance

The manifest labels books by teaching style: explanatory, reference, exercise, hybrid, model games, psychology, training system, engine-assisted, research, essays, autobiographical games, and move-by-move. Retrieval should use that label. A reference manual is strong for exact definitions; an exercise book is strong for training; a first-person game collection is strong for reconstructing thought.

New all-aspects catalogue

Status means whether an official publisher excerpt is already present locally. Acquisition-only entries remain intentional targets for a lawfully purchased full edition.

01 Strategy and Positional Play

Plans, imbalances, prophylaxis, piece improvement, structures, and long-term decision-making

01 Positional Decision Making in Chess

ACQUISITION ITEM

Boris Gelfand (GM) | Quality Chess, 2015 | explanatory | foundation

Coverage: Positional sacrifices, squeezes, space, and transformations explained through elite games

A world-championship challenger explains how elite players judge quiet positions rather than merely reporting engine moves.

02 Dynamic Decision Making in Chess

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Boris Gelfand and Jacob Aagaard (GM / GM) | Quality Chess, 2017 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Dynamic advantages, initiative, sacrifices, and the practical choice between competing continuations

Pairs first-person elite insight with rigorous editorial structure for positions where static rules are insufficient.

03 Technical Decision Making in Chess

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Boris Gelfand and Jacob Aagaard (GM / GM) | Quality Chess, 2020 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Conversion, restriction, technical choices, and winning without immediate tactics

A high-level source for the deceptively hard phase between gaining an edge and converting it.

04 Chess Structures: A Grandmaster Guide

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Mauricio Flores Rios (GM) | Quality Chess, 2015 | reference | foundation

Coverage: Twenty-eight major pawn structures with plans, typical manoeuvres, and model games

The best bridge from an opening position to the plans and piece placements that actually follow.

05 Chess Imbalances: A Grandmaster Guide

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Mauricio Flores Rios (GM) | Quality Chess, 2025 | reference | core

Coverage: Material, structural, spatial, and piece-quality imbalances in modern practice

A modern companion to Chess Structures that gives the coach a vocabulary for comparing unlike advantages.

06 Grandmaster Preparation: Positional Play

ACQUISITION ITEM

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2012 | exercise | foundation

Coverage: Positional exercises on weaknesses, prophylaxis, piece placement, and transformation

A demanding exercise book that turns strategic concepts into decisions the reader must make.

07 Grandmaster Preparation: Strategic Play

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2013 | exercise | core

Coverage: Complex strategic exercises where calculation and positional judgement meet

Useful when a game error was not tactical but arose from choosing the wrong long-term direction.

08 The Complete Manual of Positional Chess, Volume 1

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Konstantin Sakaev and Konstantin Landa (GM / GM) | New In Chess, 2016 | reference | core

Coverage: Middlegame planning, pawn play, piece coordination, and positional technique

A systematic two-GM curriculum with broad topic coverage and many modern examples.

09 The Complete Manual of Positional Chess, Volume 2

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Konstantin Sakaev and Konstantin Landa (GM / GM) | New In Chess, 2017 | reference | core

Coverage: Dynamic positional themes, defence, attack, transformation, and practical technique

Completes the systematic curriculum and supplies source material for less tidy strategic positions.

10 Small Steps 2 Success

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Sam Shankland (GM) | Quality Chess, 2018 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Pawn moves, long-term consequences, and disciplined strategic improvement

Shankland's pawn-move lens is concrete enough to turn vague positional advice into actionable lessons.

11 Under the Surface, Second Edition

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jan Markos (GM) | Quality Chess, 2025 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Hidden positional logic, practical choices, psychology, and non-obvious resources

An unusually clear source for explaining why a natural-looking move can still misunderstand the position.

12 Beyond Material

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Davorin Kuljasevic (GM) | New In Chess, 2019 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Initiative, domination, king safety, and material-versus-activity trade-offs

Directly addresses the human tendency to count material while missing stronger dynamic factors.

13 Mastering Chess Strategy

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Johan Hellsten (GM) | Everyman Chess, 2010 | hybrid | foundation

Coverage: Structured strategic course with examples and more than 350 exercises

A proven course that combines explanation with enough practice to test whether a lesson has stuck.

02 Middlegame and Pawn Structures

The transition from opening to middlegame, pawn structures, exchanges, and recurring technical themes

01 Winning Chess Middlegames, Revised Edition

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Ivan Sokolov (GM) | New In Chess, 2025 | reference | foundation

Coverage: Typical pawn structures and plans from a practical grandmaster perspective

A classic structure-led middlegame manual refreshed for modern theory and engine scrutiny.

02 Mastering Chess Middlegames

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Alexander Panchenko (GM) | New In Chess, 2015 | reference | core

Coverage: Defence, counterplay, converting advantages, piece battles, and heavy-piece play

Distils the curriculum of a famed grandmaster school into reusable middlegame themes.

03 Chess Middlegame Strategies, Volume 1

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Ivan Sokolov (GM) | Thinkers Publishing, 2017 | model-games | core

Coverage: Modern model games grouped by structural and strategic themes

Supplies current, concrete model games for plans that abstract manuals sometimes state too generally.

04 Mastering Chess Exchanges

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard and Renier Castellanos (GM / GM) | Quality Chess, 2025 | explanatory | core

Coverage: When to exchange, what remains afterward, and how exchanges reshape evaluation

Exchange decisions are a major blind spot in automated annotations; this book gives them a dedicated framework.

05 Understanding Chess Exchanges

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Johan Hellsten (GM) | New In Chess, 2024 | hybrid | core

Coverage: Practical exchange decisions across strategic, attacking, defensive, and endgame settings

Adds graded examples and exercises to one of the most consequential decisions in chess.

06 The Power of Pawns

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jorg Hickl (GM) | New In Chess, 2016 | explanatory | foundation

Coverage: Pawn structures, breaks, chains, majorities, islands, and practical rules of thumb

A highly accessible structural primer that complements the denser grandmaster references.

07 Understanding Chess Middlegames

EXCERPT INSTALLED

John Nunn (GM) | Gambit Publications, 2011 | reference | foundation

Coverage: One hundred compact lessons covering attack, defence, structure, pieces, and planning

Compact lesson units are ideal retrieval targets when the coach needs one precise concept rather than a whole chapter.

03 Thinking and Calculation

Candidate moves, visualization, calculation discipline, evaluation, time use, and the psychology of error

01 Grandmaster Preparation: Calculation

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2012 | exercise | foundation

Coverage: Candidate moves, forcing lines, comparison, and demanding calculation exercises

The calculation shelf's central deliberate-practice source, built around solving rather than passive reading.

02 Grandmaster Preparation: Thinking Inside the Box

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2018 | explanatory | foundation

Coverage: Decision-making, four types of chess decisions, analysis habits, and training design

Provides the overarching decision model that helps classify why a move was missed.

03 Improve Your Chess Calculation

EXCERPT INSTALLED

R.B. Ramesh (GM) | New In Chess, 2022 | hybrid | foundation

Coverage: Visualization, candidate moves, calculation errors, evaluation, and training methods

A celebrated modern coach gives a practical, teachable calculation process suitable for post-game diagnosis.

04 Think Like a Super-GM

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Michael Adams and Philip Hurtado (GM / researcher) | Quality Chess, 2022 | research | core

Coverage: How players of different strengths think through the same positions

The comparison data helps an AI coach distinguish expert attention from club-player thought patterns.

05 Pump Up Your Rating

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Axel Smith (GM) | Quality Chess, 2013 | training-system | foundation

Coverage: A complete improvement system spanning thinking, analysis, openings, and tournament practice

A concrete long-term training system, not just a collection of isolated tips.

06 How to Study Chess on Your Own

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Davorin Kuljasevic (GM) | New In Chess, 2021 | training-system | foundation

Coverage: Self-study planning, game analysis, model games, exercises, and engine use

Directly informs how the product should convert a single analysed game into a sustainable study plan.

07 The Secret Ingredient

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jan Markos and David Navara (GM / GM) | Quality Chess, 2021 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Practical decision-making, psychology, concentration, time trouble, and competitive habits

Connects chess skill to the human conditions under which decisions are actually made.

08 The Seven Deadly Chess Sins

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jonathan Rowson (GM) | Gambit Publications, 2000 | psychology | core

Coverage: Recurring cognitive errors including thinking, blinking, wanting, materialism, and ego

A classic taxonomy of why strong players repeatedly make recognisable kinds of mistakes.

09 Chess for Zebras

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jonathan Rowson (GM) | Gambit Publications, 2005 | psychology | core

Coverage: Skill, effort, colour, practical chess, and the limits of rule-based thinking

Challenges simplistic improvement advice and adds a sophisticated account of practical skill.

10 Improve Your Chess Now, New Edition

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jonathan Tisdall (GM) | New In Chess, 2023 | hybrid | core

Coverage: Calculation, visualization, analysis methods, and practical shortcuts

An experienced player's toolkit for calculating efficiently rather than attempting exhaustive search.

11 Chess Improvement: It's All in the Mindset

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Barry Hymer and Peter Wells (psychologist / GM) | Crown House Publishing, 2020 | psychology | core

Coverage: Mindset, motivation, learning from losses, confidence, and durable improvement

Adds evidence-informed learning psychology so the coach can respond constructively to frustration and plateaus.

04 Tactics and Combinations

Pattern recognition, forcing play, mating attacks, tactical defence, and deliberate exercise practice

01 The Woodpecker Method

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Axel Smith and Hans Tikkanen (GM / GM) | Quality Chess, 2018 | exercise | foundation

Coverage: Cyclical repetition of tactical exercises for speed, accuracy, and pattern recognition

The best-known modern system for turning tactical knowledge into fast pattern recognition.

02 The Woodpecker Method 2

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Axel Smith (GM) | Quality Chess, 2024 | exercise | core

Coverage: Cyclical training with positional and strategic exercises as well as tactics

Extends spaced, repeated solving beyond combinations into the quieter decisions games often hinge on.

03 The Magic of Chess Tactics 2

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Karsten Muller and Claus-Dieter Meyer (GM / trainer) | Russell Enterprises, 2017 | hybrid | core

Coverage: Rich tactical motifs, combinations, defensive ideas, and test positions

A varied motif source with unusually detailed explanations rather than bare solutions.

04 The Complete Chess Swindler

EXCERPT INSTALLED

David Smerdon (GM) | New In Chess, 2020 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Practical tricks, traps, psychology, resistance, and saving bad positions

Teaches resourcefulness and opponent-facing practical play that engine-only analysis tends to undervalue.

05 Mating the Castled King

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Danny Gormally (GM) | Quality Chess, 2014 | hybrid | core

Coverage: Recurring mating patterns against kings castled short or long

A focused pattern library for explaining why an attack works, not only where the engine found mate.

06 Chess Tactics from Scratch

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Martin Weteschnik (IM) | Quality Chess, 2012 | explanatory | foundation

Coverage: Systematic explanations of pins, forks, discovered attacks, overload, and tactical geometry

An exceptional specialist inclusion whose conceptual explanations make basic motifs retrievable and teachable.

05 Attack and Defence

Building attacks, converting initiative, resisting threats, counterplay, and defensive resourcefulness

01 Attacking Manual 1, Second Edition

ACQUISITION ITEM

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2017 | explanatory | foundation

Coverage: Bringing pieces into an attack, momentum, colour schemes, quantity, and attack principles

A systematic modern theory of attacking play from one of the leading chess trainers.

02 Attacking Manual 2

ACQUISITION ITEM

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2010 | hybrid | core

Coverage: Typical attacking patterns, breakthroughs, intuitive sacrifices, and conversion

Completes Aagaard's attack curriculum with extensive examples and exercises.

03 Grandmaster Preparation: Attack and Defence

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2013 | exercise | foundation

Coverage: Calculation-heavy exercises in attack, defence, initiative, and counterplay

Forces the reader to switch perspective between creating threats and finding defensive resources.

04 Mastering Chess Defence

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Johan Hellsten (GM) | New In Chess, 2025 | hybrid | foundation

Coverage: Threat recognition, counterthreats, material decisions, king safety, and long-term defence

A comprehensive modern defence course that corrects the common library bias toward attack.

06 Endgames

Essential theory, practical technique, rook endings, patterns, tactics, and modern tablebase corrections

01 100 Endgames You Must Know

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jesus de la Villa (GM) | New In Chess, 2015 | reference | foundation

Coverage: The essential theoretical positions required for practical tournament play

An international bestseller and the clearest compact baseline for essential endgame knowledge.

02 100 Endgame Patterns You Must Know

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jesus de la Villa (GM) | New In Chess, 2022 | hybrid | foundation

Coverage: Recurring practical endgame patterns that support recognition and calculation

Complements exact theoretical positions with patterns that transfer across many endings.

03 Dvoretsky's Endgame Manual, Sixth Edition

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Mark Dvoretsky (IM / elite trainer) | Russell Enterprises, 2025 | reference | foundation

Coverage: Authoritative endgame theory, technique, analysis, and modern corrections

The canonical advanced manual; the sixth edition keeps the reference aligned with modern checking.

04 Theoretical Rook Endgames

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Sam Shankland (GM) | Quality Chess, 2023 | reference | foundation

Coverage: Core rook-endgame theory organised for learning and tournament use

A modern, learnable treatment of the ending type players encounter most often.

05 Conceptual Rook Endgames

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2023 | explanatory | core

Coverage: Practical rook-endgame ideas, decision rules, and conceptual technique

Pairs with Shankland: one supplies the theory, the other explains how to think when memory is insufficient.

06 Grandmaster Preparation: Endgame Play

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard (GM) | Quality Chess, 2014 | exercise | core

Coverage: Advanced endgame calculation and technique through difficult exercises

Converts endgame knowledge into calculation practice under realistic difficulty.

07 Understanding Chess Endgames, Revised and Corrected Edition

ACQUISITION ITEM

John Nunn (GM) | Gambit Publications, 2026 | reference | foundation

Coverage: One hundred essential endgame ideas rechecked with current engines and tablebases

The 2026 revision is unusually well suited to a truth-seeking corpus because the analysis was rechecked with current technology.

08 Nunn's Chess Endings, Volume 1

EXCERPT INSTALLED

John Nunn (GM) | Gambit Publications, 2010 | reference | specialist

Coverage: Practical pawn, minor-piece, queen, and mixed endings without rooks

Combines rigorous analysis with narrative explanations of difficult practical endings.

09 Nunn's Chess Endings, Volume 2

ACQUISITION ITEM

John Nunn (GM) | Gambit Publications, 2010 | reference | specialist

Coverage: Practical rook endings and rook-plus-minor-piece endings

An advanced companion focused on the most common and demanding family of practical endings.

10 Mastering Endgame Strategy

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Johan Hellsten (GM) | Everyman Chess, 2008 | hybrid | foundation

Coverage: Endgame planning, king activity, passed pawns, exchanges, and practical technique

A structured course that teaches what to aim for before exact calculation begins.

11 Endgame Labyrinths

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jacob Aagaard and Steffen Nielsen (GM / GM) | Quality Chess, 2022 | exercise | specialist

Coverage: One thousand challenging endgame studies and practical calculation positions

A deep calculation bank for advanced users after the foundational theory is in place.

12 Van Perlo's Endgame Tactics, Modernized and Improved Edition

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Ger van Perlo (correspondence GM) | New In Chess, 2026 | model-games | core

Coverage: Entertaining, memorable tactical motifs drawn from practical endgames

Keeps the endgame shelf lively and builds recognition of tricks that purely theoretical manuals omit.

07 Practical Improvement and Computer Chess

Training design, engine-assisted learning, modern chess discoveries, resilience, and transferable lessons

01 Game Changer

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Matthew Sadler and Natasha Regan (GM / WIM) | New In Chess, 2019 | engine-assisted | foundation

Coverage: AlphaZero's games, strategic discoveries, sacrifices, piece play, and implications for human chess

A landmark account of what a radically different engine taught strong human players about chess.

02 The Silicon Road to Chess Improvement

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Matthew Sadler (GM) | New In Chess, 2021 | engine-assisted | foundation

Coverage: Using modern engines to analyse, train, explore openings, and improve human understanding

The most directly relevant source for designing a coach that uses engines without surrendering explanation to them.

03 Re-Engineering the Chess Classics

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Matthew Sadler and Steve Giddins (GM / author) | New In Chess, 2022 | engine-assisted | core

Coverage: Classic games revisited with neural engines and modern explanatory insight

Demonstrates how computer discoveries and human narrative can correct and enrich older annotations together.

04 The Moves That Matter

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jonathan Rowson (GM) | Bloomsbury, 2019 | essays | specialist

Coverage: Chess, life, attention, judgement, beauty, competition, and meaning

Adds reflective context and humane coaching language that a purely technical library would lack.

08 Master Games and Chess Wisdom

Deeply annotated games, elite-player self-explanation, historical styles, and whole-game understanding

01 Learn from the Legends, Third Edition

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Mihail Marin (GM) | Quality Chess, 2018 | model-games | foundation

Coverage: The distinctive strengths of great champions, shown through deeply annotated games

A celebrated bridge between chess history and transferable strategic technique.

02 Learn from the Legends 2

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Mihail Marin (GM) | Quality Chess, 2025 | model-games | core

Coverage: A new set of elite players and the characteristic skills that made each exceptional

Extends the model-player method into modern chess and broadens the stylistic reference set.

03 How I Beat Fischer's Record

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Judit Polgar (GM) | Quality Chess, 2012 | autobiographical-games | core

Coverage: Polgar's early development and games, annotated with first-person insight

First-person annotations connect concrete moves to the development of an elite attacking player.

04 From GM to Top Ten

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Judit Polgar (GM) | Quality Chess, 2013 | autobiographical-games | core

Coverage: The climb from grandmaster to world top ten through annotated games

Shows how opening, calculation, psychology, and practical choices evolve at the highest level.

05 A Game of Queens

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Judit Polgar (GM) | Quality Chess, 2014 | autobiographical-games | core

Coverage: Elite career games, rivals, world championship context, and personal reflections

Completes one of the strongest modern first-person game collections.

06 Timman's Titans

EXCERPT INSTALLED

Jan Timman (GM) | New In Chess, 2016 | model-games | core

Coverage: Portraits and annotated encounters with the world champions Timman faced

Combines personal knowledge, historical context, and high-level annotations across many playing styles.

07 Grandmaster Chess Move by Move

ACQUISITION ITEM

John Nunn (GM) | Gambit Publications, 2005 | move-by-move | foundation

Coverage: Complete games with explanations of the purpose and alternatives behind nearly every move

Move-by-move commentary is ideal grounding for answering the user's central question: what was I supposed to be thinking here?

Opening shelf index

The opening shelf remains intact in its existing folder and has its own detailed catalogue. This index folds every title into the combined retrieval map.

TITLE	AUTHOR	SHELF	PRIORITY
FCO: Fundamental Chess Openings	Paul van der Sterren	01 General and Method	foundation
Grandmaster Opening Preparation	Jaan Ehvest	01 General and Method	foundation
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the French, Caro-Kann and Philidor	Parimarjan Negi	02 W: 1.e4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the Sicilian I	Parimarjan Negi	02 W: 1.e4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the Sicilian II	Parimarjan Negi	02 W: 1.e4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the Sicilian III	Parimarjan Negi	02 W: 1.e4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs Minor Defences	Parimarjan Negi	02 W: 1.e4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 1A: The Catalan	Boris Avrukh	03 W: 1.d4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 1B: The Queen's Gambit	Boris Avrukh	03 W: 1.d4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 2A: King's Indian and Gruenfeld	Boris Avrukh	03 W: 1.d4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 2B: Dynamic Systems	Boris Avrukh	03 W: 1.d4	core
The Powerful Catalan	Victor Bologan	03 W: 1.d4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 3: The English Opening Volume One	Mihail Marin	04 W: English and Reti	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 4: The English Opening Volume Two	Mihail Marin	04 W: English and Reti	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 5: The English Opening Volume Three	Mihail Marin	04 W: English and Reti	core
The Modern Reti: An Anti-Slav Repertoire	Alexander Delchev	04 W: English and Reti	core
Bologan's Black Weapons in the Open Games	Victor Bologan	05 B: 1.e4 e5	foundation
Bologan's Ruy Lopez for Black	Victor Bologan	05 B: 1.e4 e5	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Berlin Defence	Michael Roiz	05 B: 1.e4 e5	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Sicilian Taimanov	Antonios Pavlidis	06 B: Sicilian	core
The Modernized Sicilian Kan	Adrien Demuth	06 B: Sicilian	core
Bologan's Caro-Kann	Victor Bologan	07 B: Other vs 1.e4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 14: The French Defence Volume One	Emanuel Berg	07 B: Other vs 1.e4	specialist
Grandmaster Repertoire 15: The French Defence Volume Two	Emanuel Berg	07 B: Other vs 1.e4	specialist
Grandmaster Repertoire 16: The French Defence Volume Three	Emanuel Berg	07 B: Other vs 1.e4	specialist
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Pirc Defence	Mihail Marin	07 B: Other vs 1.e4	core
The Modern Tiger	Tiger Hillarp Persson	07 B: Other vs 1.e4	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: King's Indian 1	Gawain Jones	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: King's Indian 2	Gawain Jones	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Nimzo-Indian Defence	Michael Roiz	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Queen's Indian Defence	Michael Roiz	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 20: The Semi-Slav	Lars Schandorff	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 12: The Modern Benoni	Marian Petrov	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	specialist
Grandmaster Repertoire: Leningrad Dutch	Mihail Marin	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	core
Grandmaster Repertoire: Dutch Sidelines	Mihail Marin	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	specialist
The Safest Gruenfeld	Alexander Delchev and Evgenij Agrest	08 B: 1.d4 and Flank	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 19: Beating Minor Openings	Victor Mikhalevski	09 Sidelines and Specialists	core
Grandmaster Repertoire 11: Beating 1.d4 Sidelines	Boris Avrukh	09 Sidelines and Specialists	core
Fighting the London System	Kiril Georgiev	09 Sidelines and Specialists	specialist

Validation and hand-off

Before this catalogue was added, the source-corpus audit found 96 readable PDFs out of 96 checked. 1 file(s) were flagged as likely image-only from sampled-page text extraction. The final machine report also includes this catalogue. Image-only is not corruption, but those files will require OCR before passage retrieval.

Files to use

FILE	ROLE
AI Chess Coach Library catalogue.json	Machine-readable source registry for ingestion, filtering, priority, source style, URL, and local path
PDF validation report.json	Readability, page count, sampled text, and image-only flags for every local PDF
README - Library workflow.md	Short operational and rights guide for adding purchased books later
Opening Books/00 Shelf Guide	The original detailed opening-specific catalogue and audit

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Books supply human concepts, vocabulary, model games, and training advice. Engines and tablebases verify concrete claims. The coach should preserve that division instead of calling either source infallible.